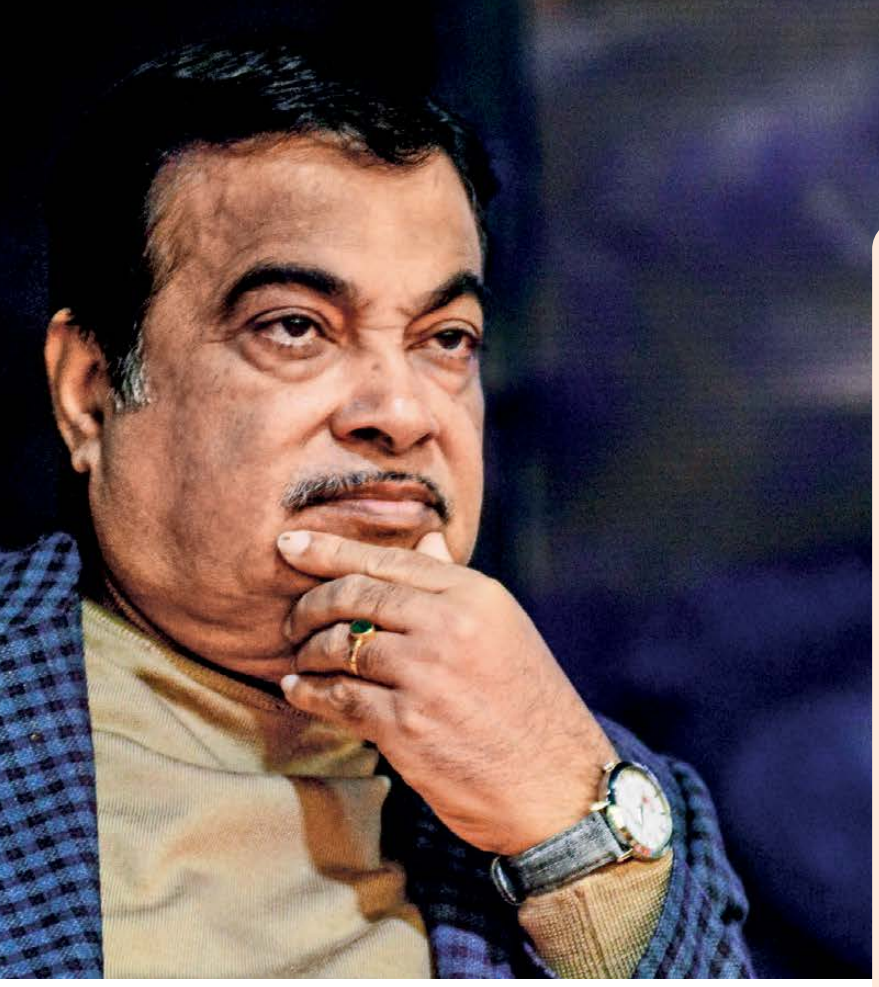


NITIN GADKARI, *64* | BJP

Minister of Road Transport & Highways

↘ **From the ranks** Holding M.Com. and LL.B. degrees from Nagpur University, Gadkari actively worked with the ABVP and the BJYM

↘ **Bipartisan appeal** Gadkari enjoys personal goodwill on both sides of the political aisle while maintaining a reputation as a performer in the Modi government. A former party president and close to the RSS, he is arguably the only minister who is openly praised by the Opposition in Parliament. As the longest-serving road transport & highways minister—he has held the same portfolio since 2014—Gadkari can be candid about the shortcomings in his ministry

↘ **Family man** Gadkari is often spotted in his hometown and constituency of Nagpur, shopping and enjoying an ice cream with his family, especially his grandchildren

EXPERTSPEAK



GAURAV VAANGAL
Associate Director, Light Vehicle Production Forecast, Indian subcontinent, S&P Global Mobility

"The government should work to remove congestion within cities. Today, you take two hours from Gurgaon to Delhi wading through congestion in peak time. And you also take two hours from Gurgaon to Jaipur via the Mumbai Expressway"

PLANET FIRST

Greening initiatives, like the Green Highways Mission aiming to plant 140 million trees by 2030, should be prioritised. Additionally, the vehicle scrappage policy should be rigorously implemented to remove old, polluting vehicles from roads, further promoting environmental sustainability

E-VEHICLES AND GREEN FUEL

The proliferation and adoption of sustainable transport solutions have been slow despite being a priority area of the government, especially in its fight against air pollution. Be it electric vehicles and their charging infrastructure or "green" fuel to replace petrol and diesel, the pace of policy intervention now needs to pick up

Ministers of State



AJAY TAMTA, *51* | BJP

↘ **Dalit face** The prominent three-time Dalit MP from Almora, Uttarakhand, was appointed MoS (Textiles) in 2016. He has also previously served as the state's horticulture minister in the B.C. Khanduri government



HARSH MALHOTRA, *58* | BJP

↘ **Organisation man** The first-time MP from East Delhi has previously served as the mayor of East Delhi Municipal Corporation. A lawyer by education, he is a vocal advocate for organ donation and has been a dedicated BJP member since joining its youth wing in 1984